

Marcelo Denis Woo

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EDUCATION

PhD in Economics University of Nottingham	Oct. 2021 – Present Nottingham, U.K.
MRes in Economics (Top student) University of Nottingham	Oct. 2020 – Sep. 2021 Nottingham, U.K.
Diploma in Machine Learning and Deep Learning Instituto Tecnológico de Buenos Aires (ITBA)	2019 Buenos Aires, Argentina
Master in Economics (Best dissertation) Universidad de San Andrés	2019 Buenos Aires, Argentina
B.A. in Economics Universidad de San Andrés	2011 Buenos Aires, Argentina

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied Microeconomics, Behavioral Economics, Applied Economics

JOB MARKET PAPER

Contagious Ignorance: Theory and Experiment on Information Avoidance in Groups [PDF](#)

with Silvia Sonderegger and Fabio Tufano

We study whether the deliberate avoidance of useful and freely available information can be interdependent across people. Agents derive direct utility from their beliefs about their state-dependent future consumption, potentially creating an incentive to avoid belief-inducing information. Building on Bénabou (2013), our model predicts that when remaining ignorant imposes negative externalities on others' future payoffs, individuals' decisions to acquire or avoid information may exhibit strategic complementarities (making ignorance contagious), strategic substitutabilities (making it self-limiting), or be unconditional. We test these predictions in a novel experiment where participants choose whether to learn a payoff-relevant state and where remaining ignorant worsens future payoffs of all group members. Consistent with contagious ignorance, exogenously increasing expectations about the prevalence of information avoidance raises participants' own propensity to avoid information. Evidence suggests this contagion of ignorance is mediated by a deterioration in anticipatory utility upon learning bad news, which become more severe as ignorance becomes more common. Individuals differ substantially in their best-responses to others' informational choices: around 40% of subjects condition their informational choices on those of others, split evenly between strategic complements and strategic substitutes. The mixture of such types affects equilibrium share of information avoiders monotonically and nonlinearly. Our findings suggest that optimal incentive schemes aiming to promote the aggregate take-up of information should account for interdependences in information decisions.

PUBLICATIONS

Discrimination with Inaccurate Beliefs and Confirmation Bias [PDF](#)

with Christian Ruzzier. *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*, June 2023.

We examine patterns of discrimination when employers hold incorrect beliefs about the relationship between group membership and productivity, and suffer from confirmation bias when updating their beliefs. As a result, employers do not correct them fully, leading to persistent wage discrimination. Negative stereotypes generate discrimination

against minority workers upon entry to the labor market, but are not enough to have discrimination in the long run, and reversals in discrimination are possible. We also discuss whether interventions aimed at reducing discrimination would succeed if confirmation bias is an important source of discrimination, and consider segregation in an extension with heterogeneous employers.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Mercado Libre

Buenos Aires, Argentina

Largest e-commerce and fintech company in Latin America ([More Info](#))

Data Scientist, Marketing Science

Mar. 2020 – Aug. 2020

- **Big Data Processing:** Processed 900M+ monthly transactions (e-commerce & fintech) in SQL, enabling marketing analytics across 18 countries.

Samsung Electronics

Buenos Aires, Argentina

Product Manager, Product & Marketing, Digital Appliances Division

Mar. 2016 – Feb. 2020

- **Best Employee Award:** Overcame several external delays in product development to achieve on-time launch of air conditioners (with demand concentrated in 2 months) by shortening critical path of logistics by 1 month, securing 15% of division's annual revenue target.
- **Cross-Functional Leadership:** Partnered with cross-functional teams (sales, marketing, supply chain, customer service) across three countries to drive product and marketing strategy, managing 50% of the division's revenue.

Supply Chain Management Coordinator, Digital Appliances Division

Mar. 2013 – Mar. 2016

- **Operational Excellence Award:** Achieved >90% Forecast Accuracy (vs. 70% target) and > 90% Sales Target Accuracy, key results contributing to the subsidiary's Global Operational Excellence Award for 16 consecutive months.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Nottingham

Nottingham, UK

Postgraduate Teaching Assistant (PGTA)

Sep. 2021 – Present

Introduction to Microeconomics, Quantitative Methods, Applied Econometrics I & II, Politics of Economics, Experimental & Behavioural Economics, Economics Dissertation.

Universidad de San Andrés

Buenos Aires, Argentina

Top Economics department in Argentina ([Link](#))

Invited Professor, Department of Economics

June 2022 – Present

Behavioral Economics

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University of Nottingham, Professor [John Gathergood](#)

Nottingham, UK

Research Assistant

Jul. 2023 – Nov. 2023

- Project on gender inequalities in academia in the U.K. Built database by parallelizing webscraping of information about 88,000 U.K. research outputs and their authors with Python's `beautifulsoup` library. Used a Machine Learning algorithm to classify authors' gender based on first and middle names.

University of Nottingham, Professor [Valeria Rueda](#)

Nottingham, UK

Research Assistant

Nov. 2021 – Sep. 2022

- Project on [the effect of political activism on women's electoral participation](#). Webscraped and built database of the universe of U.K. parliament speeches on gender and the woman's suffrage movement from 1910-1914 (11,700 speeches) in Python. Implemented text-analysis.

AWARDS & CERTIFICATIONS

Academic Awards

- Visiting at [IZA/University of Bonn](#), hosted by **Prof. Florian Zimmermann**
- **Best PhD student presentation**, Year 2. PhD Annual Conference, University of Nottingham, 2023.
- **Best Performance in MRes** in Economics (top score), University of Nottingham, 2021.
- **RIDGE-Nottingham Scholarship**: full funding for 5 years (awarded to only 1 student from Latin America).
- **Best Dissertation in Master in Economics** (Top of 40+ theses), Universidad de San Andrés, 2019.
- **Teaching Excellence Award**, University of Nottingham, 2021/22 and 2022/23.

Industry Awards

- **Best employee award** for “outstanding behavior and valuable contributions to business”, Samsung Electronics, 2017 (among 200+ eligible employees).
- **Global Operational Excellence award** (key contributor for award at subsidiary level), Samsung Electronics, 2016.

Certifications / Courses

- “Foundations of Machine Learning”, University of Oxford (taught by Maximilian Kasy), Sep. 2024.
- “Randomized Controlled Trials”, Barcelona School of Economics (Owen Ozier & Pamela Jakiela), Jul. 2023.
- “Statistics”, “Fundamentals of Programming”, and “Fundamentals of Linear Algebra”, Master in Information and Data Science (MIDS), U.C. Berkeley, 2020.¹
- “Gender Economics”, Paris School of Economics, Jun. 2023.
- “Statistical Learning in R” (with distinction), Stanford University, Mar. 2020.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Econometrics, Machine Learning & Data Science: Python, Stata, R, SQL

Experiments & Surveys: Qualtrics, Lioness.

Data Visualization: Tableau, Matplotlib/Seaborn/Plotnine, ggplot2.

Version Control: Git

LANGUAGES

Spanish (native) | English (proficient) | Korean (intermediate) | French (basic).

SERVICE

- Volunteered to provide induction on Korean culture to Argentinean new hires, enhancing cross-cultural understanding and preventing unnecessary frictions at work for 20+ new employees annually.
- PhD Representative, [Centre for Decision Research and Experimental Economics \(CeDEx\)](#), 2024-2025.
- Co-organiser of CeDEx Brown Bag seminars, 2022-2024.

¹Dropped out from further modules due to funding constraints.

REFERENCES

Professor Silvia Sonderegger

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Professor Simon Gächter

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Professor Fabio Tufano

University of Leicester

School of Business, Department of Economics, Finance,
and Accounting

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